Hotel Furniture QC Checklist

Twenty-four checkpoints across five production stages. Written to be used on the factory floor and filed afterwards, not read once and forgotten.

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> **How to use it.** Each row produces a document. If a checkpoint has no evidence attached, it has not been passed — it has only been discussed. Print the table, carry it into the factory, and photograph what you see. The photographs are the checklist; the ticks are just an index.

Stage 1 — Pre-production

Nothing is released into production until these four are closed. This is where most quality failures are actually decided.

Checkpoint	What to check	Evidence to collect	Pass criteria
Pre-production	Signed sample or approved mock-up exists and is stored on site	Signed approval sheet + photo of the retained sample	Approval dated before the PO release date
Pre-production	Shop drawings match the FF&E schedule revision issued for construction	Drawing register with revision numbers	Same revision on drawing, schedule and PO
Pre-production	Materials and finishes match the approved sample, not the catalogue	Material swatch photos with labels	No substitution without written approval
Pre-production	Certificate set checked against the shipment date	Certificate index (item / standard / holder / number / date)	Every item covered, holder named

Stage 2 — Frame and construction

Inspect before upholstery hides the work. Once a frame is covered, the only remedy is replacement.

Checkpoint	What to check	Evidence to collect	Pass criteria
Frame stage	Timber moisture content within 8–12% for solid wood components	Moisture meter reading log	No reading outside range on structural parts
Frame stage	Joint construction: dowel, mortise or hardware as specified	Close-up photos of joints, one per construction type	No visible gaps, no dry joints, no excess glue
Frame stage	Hardware positions set out from the drawing, not from habit	Template check photo with tape measure in frame	Within ±2 mm of the drawing

Stage 3 — Upholstery and soft components

Fabric and foam are where a specification quietly degrades. Check the combination, not the individual components.

Checkpoint	What to check	Evidence to collect	Pass criteria
Upholstery	Foam density and grade match the specification	Supplier foam certificate + cut-off sample	Density ≥ specified value

Checkpoint	What to check	Evidence to collect	Pass criteria
Upholstery	Fabric direction, pattern matching and repeat alignment	Photos of a matched seam and a corner	Pattern continuous across seams
Upholstery	Stitching: stitch density, seam allowance, no skipped stitches	Photo of a seam at 1:1	Consistent density, no puckering
Upholstery	Fire performance of the fabric and foam combination	Test report for the actual combination	Report names both fabric and foam

Stage 4 — Finishing

Finish is the only defect a guest sees. Judge it under the light the guest will see it in, and judge a room set together, not one unit at a time.

Checkpoint	What to check	Evidence to collect	Pass criteria
Finishing	Colour matched to the approved sample under the specified light source	Colour reading or side-by-side photo under D65	No visible deviation to the sample
Finishing	Surface defects: orange peel, sand-through, drips, contamination	Photo grid of one full panel per finish	AQL 2.5 or stricter on visual defects
Finishing	Edge banding and veneer direction consistent across a room set	Photos of two adjacent units together	Grain runs continuously

Stage 5 — Pre-shipment, packing and loading

This is the last point at which a defect is cheap to fix. After the seal, every correction is freight, customs and schedule.

Checkpoint	What to check	Evidence to collect	Pass criteria
Pre-shipment	AQL inspection completed on a random sample from finished stock	Inspection report with defect classification	Critical 0, major ≤ 2.5, minor ≤ 4.0
Pre-shipment	Dimensional check against the drawing on 100% of a sample set	Measurement sheet with tolerances	All within drawing tolerance
Pre-shipment	Stability, load and cycle tests where the standard requires them	Test report per model	Pass per the applicable standard
Pre-shipment	Electrical items: listing verified in the public database, not from a PDF	Screenshot of the listing entry with date	File number matches the product
Packing	Carton grade, corner protection and internal blocking adequate for sea freight	Photos of an opened and a closed carton	No movement when the carton is shaken
Packing	Cartons marked with room type, floor and item code	Photo of a marked carton end	Matches the loading plan
Packing	Packing list reconciles to the purchase order line by line	Signed reconciliation sheet	Zero unexplained variance
Loading	Container condition: dry, odour-free, no holes, no residue	Photos before loading	Clean and dry
Loading	Load plan followed, weight distributed, no floating stacks	Photos mid-load and after sealing	Matches the load plan

Checkpoint	What to check	Evidence to collect	Pass criteria
Loading	Seal number recorded and photographed	Seal photo + number in the shipping documents	Number matches the B/L

Defect classification

Class	Definition	Action
Critical	Unsafe, illegal for the market, or unusable: structural failure, missing fire compliance, sharp exposed edge, wrong electrical rating.	Stop. Do not ship. Rework or replace, re-inspect before release.
Major	Visible on installation and not acceptable to the operator: finish mismatch, wrong dimension, pattern misalignment, hardware in the wrong position.	Rework before packing. Re-inspect the affected batch.
Minor	Noticed only on close inspection and not affecting use: faint polish marks, slight shade variation on a hidden face.	Record, accept with a note, or negotiate a credit.

The five questions that expose a weak inspection

1. **“Show me the sample we approved, and its date.”** No dated sample means every judgement is opinion.
2. **“Which report covers this exact fabric and foam?”** A report for the fabric alone does not cover the composite.
3. **“Who holds this certificate, and can I check it in the register?”** A certificate without a verifiable holder is decoration.
4. **“What is the AQL, and how many units did you actually open?”** “We checked everything” is not an inspection report.
5. **“Can I see the photos from frame stage?”** If frame photos do not exist, the frame was never inspected.

Record sheet

Field	Entry
Project / hotel	
Purchase order and revision	
Factory and category	
Inspection date and inspector	
Sample reference and approval date	
Units in batch / units sampled	
Critical / major / minor count	
Result	Pass ☐ Conditional pass ☐ Fail ☐
Open actions and owner	

If you want this run by a team on the ground in Foshan rather than by the factory itself, that is what we do: **foshanFFE.com** · one purchase order, one inspection calendar, one document index.